



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Capital City Classical School
School Website: <https://capitalcityclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (Waco, TX)

Website audited: <https://bishopreicher.com/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Louis Reicher (BLR) presents a strongly Catholic, virtue-centric identity with robust theological integration, daily/weekly liturgical life, and visible reference to classical authors (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare) and Latin in the middle school program. These are all positive classical indicators. However, the site places significant emphasis on contemporary college-prep metrics (PSAT/National Merit), AP Calculus, state-of-the-art labs, and hands-on STEM/robotics—signals that, without balancing classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic/seminar, rhetoric orations, memory/recitation, scholé/restful learning), dilute the classical profile. Evidence for classical pedagogy, faculty-as-mentors language, and structured parent formation is sparse or absent on the public pages reviewed. Consequently, BLR is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with Element 1 (Religious Foundations) clearly CLASSICAL; several other categories show mixed signals. Keyword analyses and category scores below are anchored to the “Six Essential Elements” keyword framework and lexicon provided for this audit .

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found on BLR site:

- Virtue/virtues, prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance; faith, hope, charity; Christ-centered; St. Thomas Aquinas; sacred scripture; daily prayer; weekly Mass; Eucharist; liturgy (via CGS/Atrium)

2) Alignment with “Six Elements” positive indicators:

- Moral realism/virtue language (virtue, prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance) and pursuit of higher goods are explicitly present; theology is integrated (four-year theology program, sacred scripture); liturgical/communal worship is normative (daily prayer, weekly Mass, Eucharist) .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: ~14 (virtue, prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance, faith/hope/charity, Christ-centered, Aquinas, sacred scripture, daily prayer, weekly Mass, Eucharist, liturgy/Atrium, catechesis); Negative hits: 0.
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage of sub-areas (moral realism, theology, liturgy): 100%.

4) Justification:

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- Strong, explicit Catholic theological and liturgical life, with rich virtue vocabulary, directly matches the Religious Foundations profile in the lexicon (e.g., liturgy, Mass, chapel; theology, sacred scripture; virtue/prudence/justice/temperance/fortitude) .

Score: CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +14/-0 | percent_positive: 100 | percent_coverage: 100

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive: virtue, character formation, Christ-centered life; “saints and scholars” ethos suggests formation beyond information .
- Negative: college/PSAT/National Merit emphasis; AP Calculus; state-of-the-art labs (signals of measurable outcomes/college-readiness) .

2) Alignment with “Six Elements”:

- Positive indicators: cultivation of virtue/wisdom and formation language (formation, virtue, character) align with the “Purpose and Goal” positives (wisdom, virtue, formation) .
- Negative indicators: emphasis on college metrics/AP/PSAT maps to the “lack of scholé” and pragmatic/metrics-heavy signals in the negative lists .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: ~4; Negative hits: ~4.
- Percent positive: 60; Coverage: ~67% (formation/virtue strongly present; T-G-B and scholé/restfulness not explicit).

4) Justification:

- The school clearly pursues spiritual and moral formation, but the public materials also foreground modern college-prep outcomes and STEM excellence, moderating the classical orientation in this category .

Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +4/-4 | percent_positive: 60 | percent_coverage: 67

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive: classical literature; Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare; Latin in middle school; four-year theology/sacred scripture; “modern and classical languages” .
- Negative: robotics; hands-on projects/competitions; STEM fields; state-of-the-art labs; AP Calculus; PSAT/National Merit framing (signals of STEM-first/pragmatic emphasis) .

2) Alignment with “Six Elements”:

- Positive indicators include Great Books/primary sources and classical languages (Latin), plus theology as a meaningful curricular strand .
- Negative indicators: project-based/experiential/STEM-first marketing language is repeatedly present for robotics and science; “AP/PSAT” framing emphasizes modern efficiencies/outcomes .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: ~6; Negative hits: ~4.
- Percent positive: 60; Coverage: ~50% (presence of classical literature/Latin/theology; explicit Trivium/Quadrivium not stated).

4) Justification:

- BLR shows real classical content (authors/Latin/theology), yet the public framing emphasizes STEM/hands-on programs and college metrics, bringing this category to a mixed (Somewhat Classical) result .

Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +6/-4 | percent_positive: 60 | percent_coverage: 50

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY/TEACHING METHODS — NOT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive (expected): Socratic, seminar, dialectic, rhetoric speeches/orations, chanting/recitation/memory, scholé/restful learning — none evident on public pages reviewed.
- Negative: “hands-on learning,” “projects/competitions,” “coding/engineering challenges,” experiential/STEM-forward language (robotics), which the lexicon flags as negative when predominant .

2) Alignment with “Six Elements”:

- Classical pedagogy indicators (Socratic seminar; memory/recitation/chant; progymnasmata; restful learning) are absent in the crawl; language suggests project-based/experiential methods in STEM programs .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: ~4.
- Percent positive: 0; Coverage: 0%.

4) Justification:

- Given no evidence of Socratic or rhetoric practices and multiple experiential/project-centered signals, pedagogy does not meet classical benchmarks on publicly presented pages .

Score: NOT CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +0/-4 | percent_positive: 0 | percent_coverage: 0

CATEGORY 5: FACULTY — NOT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive (expected): teachers as mentors/models of virtue; “living curriculum”; a “faculty of friends”; portrait/profile of a teacher — not found on reviewed public pages.

2) Alignment with “Six Elements”:

- The classical teacher profile (virtuous mentors; collegial, wisdom-centered faculty) is not articulated on the site pages we crawled; no explicit “portrait of a teacher” or comparable language surfaced .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0 (no counter-signals, just lack of evidence).
- Percent positive: 0; Coverage: 0%.

4) Justification:

- Absence of explicit faculty-formation/mentor language yields a non-classical rating for this category (based on available materials).

Score: NOT CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +0/-0 | percent_positive: 0 | percent_coverage: 0

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS & COMMUNITY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive: “Parents appreciate how this program extends beyond the classroom... strengthen your family’s faith journey” (virtue program); regular open house/invitations to visit; schoolwide worship/-community practices (weekly Mass) that involve families indirectly .
- Not seen: explicit statements of “parent partnership/co-teachers,” parent formation/book groups/-covenants.

2) Alignment with “Six Elements”:

- Some alignment to parent partnership (faith formation carried into the home) but not fully developed into formal parent-formation or co-teacher language .

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: ~2; Negative hits: 0.
- Percent positive: 50; Coverage: ~33%.

4) Justification:

- There is clear acknowledgment of family faith life and open campus hospitality, yet we did not find structured parent-formation programming or a declared co-educator model on public pages.

Score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL | pos_neg_hits: +2/-0 | percent_positive: 50 | percent_coverage: 33

Overall Assessment

Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Strong religious/theological/liturgical foundations (Element 1) clearly align with classical Christian education frameworks (virtue language; theology as a governing discipline; schoolwide worship) .
 - Curriculum shows classical elements (Latin; classical literature; theology and scripture), tempered by modern STEM and college-prep positioning (robotics, labs, AP/PSAT marketing) .
 - Classical pedagogical signals (Socratic/seminar, rhetoric orations, recitation/chant, scholé/rest) are not visible; project-based/experiential language dominates descriptions of STEM, pulling pedagogy away from classical norms .
 - Evidence for faculty-as-mentors and parent formation is limited on public pages.
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What would move the needle (to “CLASSICAL”)

- Pedagogy: Publish explicit descriptions of classical methods:
 - Upper School: Socratic seminars, dialectic debates, rhetoric speeches/orations (e.g., capstone theses), and text-centered colloquy .
 - Lower School: Daily recitation/chanting/memory work and hymnody; articulate “restful learning/scholé” practices (unhurried contemplation) .
- Curriculum clarity:
 - Name the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and, where fitting, Quadrivium; post reading lists featuring Great Books/primary sources to anchor the “Great Conversation” .
 - Continue Latin and consider describing progression (e.g., start grades, objectives) to underscore classical languages’ role .
- Re-balance marketing:

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- Continue STEM excellence but temper hands-on/project framing with classical telos and methods; shift from outcomes-first (PSAT/AP/National Merit) to wisdom/virtue formation as the first purpose of schooling, per the classical goal set .
 - Faculty and Parent formation:
 - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate” oriented to virtue/wisdom, and outline faculty development in classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic leader training) .
 - Add parent-formation offerings (book clubs, seminars, primers on classical education), and state “parent partnership” explicitly as a school distinctive .
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Evidence Appendix (select examples)

- Virtue formation rooted in Aquinas; explicit theological and liturgical life (virtues, Mass, Eucharist, daily prayer) at BLR .
 - Middle and high school program with Latin, classical literature (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare), and theology (sacred scripture, sacramental/moral life) .
 - Robotics/STEM framing with hands-on/projects/competitions (negative pedagogy signals when pre-dominant) .
 - Keyword framework and lexicon used for scoring, per “Six Essential Elements” and classicality lexicon .
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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